Status of Redbanded Rockfish stock off the U.S. West Coast in 2027



R. Claire Rosemond[1], Jason M. Cope[1], Aaron M. Berger[1] and Alison D. Whitman[2]

1. NOAA Fisheries Northwest Fisheries Science Center, 2725 Montlake Boulevard East, Seattle, WA, 98112-2097
2. Oregon Department of Fish and Wildlife, 2040 Southeast Marine Science Drive, Newport, OR, 97365

U.S. Department of Commerce
National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration
National Marine Fisheries Service
Northwest Fisheries Science Center

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1 Executive Summary

1.1 Assessment Model

1.2 Reference Points, Stock Status, and Projections

2 Introduction

This assessment report describes the stock of Sebastes babcocki (known colloquially as the Redbanded Rockfish) coastwide from California to Washington within state and federal waters, using data through 2026 (Figure: Distribution Map). Redbanded Rockfish also goes by . This assessment does not account for populations located in other areas north of the contiguous U.S. border with Canada, nor in Alaska. This is the first benchmark stock assessment for this species in support of fisheries management decisions within the Pacific Fishery Management Council.

2.1 Distsribution and Stock Structure

Redbanded Rockfish has been observed from southern California up through the Gulf of Alaska and the Aleutian Islands. WE NEED TO GET A DENSITY MAP OF DISTRIBUTION TO SHOW CORE DISTRIBUTION. Redbanded Rockfish are generally a deep shelf to slope species that shows affinity to rocks, boulders and caves, but also are found on mixed muddy and hardbottom seafloors. The are typically solitary, so lack the large aggregations demonstrated by some rockfish species.

Hyde and Vetter (2007) presented a genetic analyses of the genus *Sebastes* and show Redbanded Rockfishbeing most related to Tiger (*S. nigrocintus*), Flag (*S. rubrivinctus*, which translates to "red-banded"), and Treefish (*S. serriceps*) Rockfishes. Treefish is more southerly and generally shallower and much more distinct in color. Tiger rockfish show similar range and depth distributions, but tend to have a deeper body and darker stripes making identification a bit easier. Flag rockfish look more similar to Redbanded Rockfish and do inhabit shelf and slope areas, but are rare north of central Oregon. There are some concerns that Flag and Redbanded Rockfishes could be misidentified in those areas of overlap, but not to the extent the assessment needs to be corrected for misidentification.

2.2 Distibution

2.3 Life History

2.4 Management History

2.5 Fishery Descriptions

2.6 Ecosystem Considerations

Ecosystem considerations and/or climate indicators were not included in this assessment.

3 Data

3.1 Life History

3.2 Catch

3.3 Indices and Standardization

3.4 Composition Data

3.5 Absolute Abundance

3.6 Environmental/Ecosystem Indicator Data

4 Assessment

4.1 Current Modeling Approach

4.2 Configuration of the Base Model

4.3 Bridging

4.4 Modeling Results

4.4.1 Parameter Estimates

4.4.2 Time Series

4.4.3 Model Fits

4.4.4 Model Diagnostics

4.5 Sensitivity Analyses

4.6 Management Benchmarks

4.7 Projections

5 Discussion

6 Acknowledgements

This document was produced using the R package asar (Schiano et al. 2026), which is free to use and publicly available on GitHub.

7 References

Hyde, J.R., and Vetter, R.D. 2007. The origin, evolution, and diversification of rockfishes of the genus Sebastes (Cuvier). Molecular Phylogenetics and Evolution **44**(2): 790–811. doi:10.1016/j.ympev.2006.12.026.

Schiano, S., Breitbart, S., and Saul, S. 2026. Asar: Build NOAA stock assessment report. Available from https://github.com/nmfs-ost/asar.

8 Figures

Please refer to the `stockplotr` package downloaded from remotes::install_github('nmfs-ost/stockplotr') to add premade figures.

9 Tables

A Appendices